STONE DISCOVER

QUALITY STONE
FOR LASTING
LEGACIES



UK TRADE BUYER TOOLKIT

Checklists and templates for buying wholesale memorials

For monumental masons, funeral directors and memorial retailers

www.stonediscover.co.uk

2026 Edition

Welcome

Thank you for downloading the UK Trade Buyer Toolkit.

Ordering memorials in volume means managing specifications, cemetery rules, costs, shipping and quality all at once. This toolkit gives you simple, practical tools to check each stage, so you can order with confidence and keep a written record of what was agreed.

It is designed to work alongside the Wholesale Memorial Buying Guide on our website, and it can be used with any supplier.

How to use this toolkit

Before your order: pages 3 to 8
While you wait for shipping: page 9
When the order is being finalised: page 10
When goods arrive: page 11
For ongoing reference: pages 12 to 14

Print the pages you need and keep them with your order file. Checkboxes can also be ticked on screen.

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From Enquiry to Delivery

A wholesale memorial order usually follows nine stages. Use this page to see what to do and what to check at each one.

Stage	What you do	What to check
1. **Enquiry**	Share product type, granite, granite colour, sizes, finish and delivery location.	Your request is specific enough for an accurate quote.
2. **Quotation**	Review the written quote.	Every line matches your request, and inclusions and exclusions are stated.
3. **Samples**	Request granite or finish samples for new products or suppliers.	Colour, grain and polish match what you expect.
4. **Drawing and design approval**	Review drawings or proofs for bespoke, carved or inscribed work.	Sizes, spelling, dates, layout and symbols.
5. **Order and payment**	Confirm the order in writing and pay any agreed deposit.	Specifications, quantities, prices, terms and clauses are in writing.
6. **Production and quality control**	Ask for progress updates or photos where available.	Dimensions, finish and lettering are inspected before despatch.
7. **Packing and dispatch**	Agree how each product type will be packed.	Packing protects corners, carved areas and polished faces.
8. **Shipping and import**	Arrange or confirm shipping, insurance and customs clearance.	Documents are complete and delivery details are correct.
9. **Inspection and support**	Inspect goods on arrival and report any issues quickly.	Photograph damage, note it on paperwork and contact your supplier promptly.



Before You Order: Specification

Order reference: Customer or job: Date:

Cemetery and compliance

- [ ] Cemetery or churchyard rules checked (height, width, thickness, material, style)
- [ ] Written approval received where the cemetery requires it
- [ ] Memorial and fixing method meet current UK memorial safety standards, such as BS 8415, and your installer's requirements

Product

- [ ] Memorial type and shape confirmed
- [ ] Height, width and thickness confirmed
- [ ] Base size and fixing method confirmed
- [ ] Kerb set size and chippings option confirmed (if applicable)
- [ ] Accessories confirmed (vases, plaques, extras)
- [ ] Quantity of each item confirmed

Stone and finish

- [ ] Granite colour chosen
- [ ] Sample or swatch requested or approved
- [ ] Finish confirmed for each face (polished, honed, rock pitch, sawn)
- [ ] Edge profile and top shape confirmed

Inscription and design

- [ ] Inscription method chosen (sandblasted, engraved, V-cut, other)
- [ ] Lettering colour chosen (for example white or gold)
- [ ] Carvings, symbols or images confirmed
- [ ] Drawing or proof approval process agreed

Notes

Checked by: Date:

Before You Order: Commercial and Logistics

Order reference: _____ Supplier: _____ Date: _____

Price and terms

☐	Quote received in writing and itemised
☐	Quote states what is included and excluded
☐	Minimum order quantity met
☐	Payment terms agreed (deposit and balance)
☐	Payment method confirmed
☐	Landed cost calculated (see page 8)

Timing

☐	Production time confirmed in writing
☐	Shipping time estimate confirmed
☐	Time buffer added for delays
☐	Customer delivery date set with a safety margin

Shipping and delivery

☐	Shipping terms agreed (ex-works, FOB, CIF or other)
☐	Packing method agreed
☐	Marine cargo insurance arranged
☐	Freight agent or customs broker confirmed
☐	Delivery address confirmed
☐	Unloading equipment and staff arranged
☐	Storage space ready

Agreement and records

☐	Order confirmation received in writing
☐	Damage and claims process agreed
☐	All approvals saved in the order file

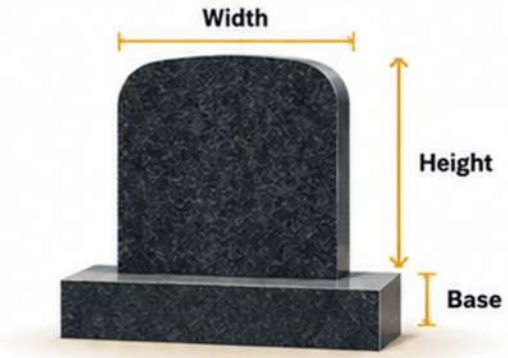
Notes

Checked by: _____ Date: _____

Standard Memorial Sizes

Always check your cemetery's size limits before ordering. Sizes below are for reference only. Fill the tables from your catalogue, in metric and imperial.

How to read memorial measurements



1. **Height:** from where the headstone meets the base to the top.
2. **Width:** the widest point across the front.
3. **Thickness:** the depth from front to back.
4. **Base:** the stone the headstone sits on.
5. Confirm whether quoted sizes include the base.

Table 1: Headstones

Shape	Height	Width	Thickness	Typical use
[Shape]	[mm / inches]	[mm / inches]	[mm / inches]	[Use]

Table 2: Bases

Base size	Width	Depth	Thickness	Suits headstone
[Size]	[mm / inches]	[mm / inches]	[mm / inches]	[Size]

Table 3: Kerb sets

Kerb set	Length	Width	Height	Chippings option
[Size]	[mm / inches]	[mm / inches]	[mm / inches]	[Yes / No]

Table 4: Vases, plaques and other items

Item	Size	Material	Notes
[Item]	[mm / inches]	[Material]	[Notes]

Tolerance note

Hand-finished stone can vary slightly in size.
Always confirm tolerances in your quote.



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Questions to Ask Any Overseas Memorial Supplier

Tick each question once answered, and score each section from 1 to 5 for each supplier.

Quality

- [ ] Do you inspect every piece before dispatch?
- [ ] Can you send photos or videos before shipping?
- [ ] How do you keep colour and grain consistent between batches?
- [ ] What size tolerance do you work to?

Score (1 to 5): Supplier A _____ Supplier B _____ Supplier C _____

Experience

- [ ] How long have you supplied memorials to the UK?
- [ ] Can you provide references or examples of UK customers?
- [ ] Do you understand UK cemetery size and style requirements?

Score (1 to 5): Supplier A _____ Supplier B _____ Supplier C _____

Process

- [ ] What is your sample policy?
- [ ] Who prepares and who approves drawings and lettering?
- [ ] How do you pack each product type, including carved pieces?
- [ ] What is your damage and claims process, and time limit?

Score (1 to 5): Supplier A _____ Supplier B _____ Supplier C _____

Commercial

- [ ] Are quotes itemised and given in writing?
- [ ] What are your payment terms?
- [ ] What is your minimum order quantity?
- [ ] What happens if there is a production or shipping delay?

Score (1 to 5): Supplier A _____ Supplier B _____ Supplier C _____

Communication

- [ ] Is there one named contact for my account?
- [ ] How quickly do you reply to enquiries?
- [ ] Are all agreements confirmed in writing?

Score (1 to 5): Supplier A _____ Supplier B _____ Supplier C _____

Total score: **A** _____ **B** _____ **C** _____

Red flags: be cautious if a supplier

Will not give a written, itemised quote or provide samples or photos.
Is vague about packing or damage claims, or cannot say who approves lettering.
Pressures you to pay in full before specifications are agreed.

Compare Quotes on the Real Cost

A low unit price can cost more once freight, duty and VAT are added. Use this sheet to compare suppliers fairly. Fill in one column per supplier.

Cost item	Supplier A	Supplier B	Supplier C
Memorial unit price			
Quantity			
Goods total			
Packing			
Transport to port of origin			
Sea freight			
Marine cargo insurance			
Import duty			
Import VAT			
Customs broker fees			
Port and handling charges			
Delivery to your yard			
Other costs			
Total landed cost			
Landed cost per piece			
Estimated breakage allowance (optional)			

How to calculate

Goods total = unit price x quantity
Total landed cost = goods total + all other costs listed
Landed cost per piece = total landed cost divided by quantity

Tips

1. Check which shipping term each quote uses (ex-works, FOB, CIF or other) so you compare like with like.
2. Ask your customs broker to confirm the commodity code and the current duty rate for your goods.
3. If you are VAT-registered, check with your accountant whether import VAT can be reclaimed.
4. Add a small allowance for delays, storage or breakage on large orders.

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Shipping, Import and Delivery

Shipping terms in brief

Term	What it generally means
Ex-works	You arrange and pay for transport from the supplier's premises onwards.
FOB (Free on Board)	The supplier delivers the goods onto the ship at the origin port. You arrange and pay for shipping from there.
CIF (Cost, Insurance and Freight)	The supplier pays for shipping and insurance to the destination port. You handle import clearance and delivery from the port.
Delivered	The supplier arranges delivery to a named location. Check what is and is not included.

Terms can be interpreted differently. Always confirm exactly what your quote includes.

Documents to have ready

- [ ] Commercial invoice
- [ ] Packing list
- [ ] Bill of lading
- [ ] Certificate of origin
- [ ] Insurance certificate
- [ ] Customs declaration
- [ ] Any other document your customs broker requires: _____

Before the shipment arrives

- [ ] Arrival date and port confirmed
- [ ] Customs clearance arranged with your broker
- [ ] Duty and VAT payment arranged
- [ ] Delivery slot booked
- [ ] Unloading equipment and trained staff arranged
- [ ] Storage area prepared
- [ ] Customer informed of expected timing

On delivery day

- [ ] Check container or vehicle seals
- [ ] Photograph the unloading
- [ ] Count pieces against the packing list
- [ ] Note any visible damage on the delivery paperwork before signing
- [ ] Keep all packaging until you have inspected everything

Key contacts

Supplier contact: _____ Phone: _____

Freight agent: _____ Phone: _____

Customs broker: _____ Phone: _____

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Inscription and Drawing Approval

Most inscription disputes come from unclear approval. Complete this form for every inscribed memorial and keep the signed copy with your order file.

Order reference: _____ Customer name: _____ Date sent: _____

Supplier contact: _____

Memorial details

Memorial type	
Stone colour	
Dimensions	
Finish	
Quantity	

Inscription check (initial each line once checked)

- ☐ Names spelt correctly — Initials: _____
- ☐ Dates correct — Initials: _____
- ☐ Wording and punctuation correct — Initials: _____
- ☐ Font and lettering size approved — Initials: _____
- ☐ Layout and spacing approved — Initials: _____
- ☐ Symbols, carvings and images approved — Initials: _____
- ☐ Lettering colour approved (white, gold or other) — Initials: _____

Final inscription text (write out in full)

Approval

I confirm that the details above are correct and approve production.

Name: _____ Signature: _____ Date: _____

Note: Changes after approval may affect cost and delivery time. [Confirm this wording matches your policy.]

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When Your Order Arrives

Order reference: _____ Supplier: _____ Date received: _____

Inspection checklist

- ☐ Packaging intact on arrival
- ☐ Quantity matches the packing list
- ☐ No cracks, chips or scratches
- ☐ Polish and finish as agreed
- ☐ Colour matches the sample or approval
- ☐ Sizes match the order (measure at least one piece of each type)
- ☐ Lettering and carving as approved
- ☐ Bases, fixings and accessories included

Damage log

Item	Description of issue	Photo taken (Y/N)	Action needed

If you find a problem

1. Photograph the damage before moving or unpacking anything further.
2. Note the damage on the delivery paperwork before signing.
3. Contact your supplier within [insert time limit, for example 48 hours or X days].
4. Keep all packaging until the claim is resolved.
5. Send the photos, this form and your order reference.
6. Keep a record of all communication.

Notes

Inspected by: _____ Date: _____

Cemetery Requirements Record

Keep a record of the rules for each cemetery you work with, and check them again before each order, since rules change.

Cemetery	Contact	Max height	Max width	Thickness	Allowed materials	Restricted finishes or styles	Approval needed	Date checked

Notes

Memorial Trade Terms

Base	The stone that a headstone sits on, usually fixed to the foundation.
Bill of lading	A shipping document issued by the carrier that lists the goods and acts as a receipt.
BS 8415	The British Standard covering the design and installation of memorials. Check the current version and your cemetery's requirements.
Certificate of origin	A document confirming the country where the goods were made.
Chippings	Decorative stone pieces used inside a kerb set.
CIF	Shipping term where the supplier pays for freight and insurance to the destination port.
Commodity code	A code used by customs to classify goods and work out duty and VAT.
Die	The main upright part of a memorial that carries the inscription, in some multi-piece designs.
Dowel	A pin used to fix a headstone to its base.
Ex-works	Shipping term where the buyer takes responsibility from the supplier's premises.
FOB	Shipping term where the supplier delivers goods onto the ship at the origin port.
Gilding	Applying gold leaf or gold paint to lettering.
Honed finish	A smooth, matt surface with no shine.
Kerb set	A stone surround that marks out a grave plot.
Landed cost	The total cost of goods delivered to you, including freight, insurance, duty, VAT and fees.
MOQ	Minimum order quantity.
Polished finish	A smooth, glossy, mirror-like surface.
Rock pitch	A rough, natural-looking edge or surface.
Sandblasted lettering	Lettering cut into stone using an abrasive blast.
Sawn finish	A plain, flat-cut surface with no polish.
V-cut lettering	Lettering cut in a V shape for a sharp, traditional look.

Ready to Request a Quote?

Complete this form and email us, or scan the QR code to request trade pricing online.

Field	Your details
Business name	
Contact name	
Email	
Phone	
Product types	
Approximate quantities	
Granite colours	
Sizes needed	
Finish	
Inscription or carving needed	
Required delivery date	
Delivery address	
Notes	

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Thank you for using the UK Trade Buyer Toolkit. We are here to help with specifications, samples and trade quotes.

Disclaimer: This toolkit is for general guidance only. Always check current cemetery rules, import regulations, customs duties and applicable standards before ordering. Confirm tax and customs details with your customs broker or accountant.